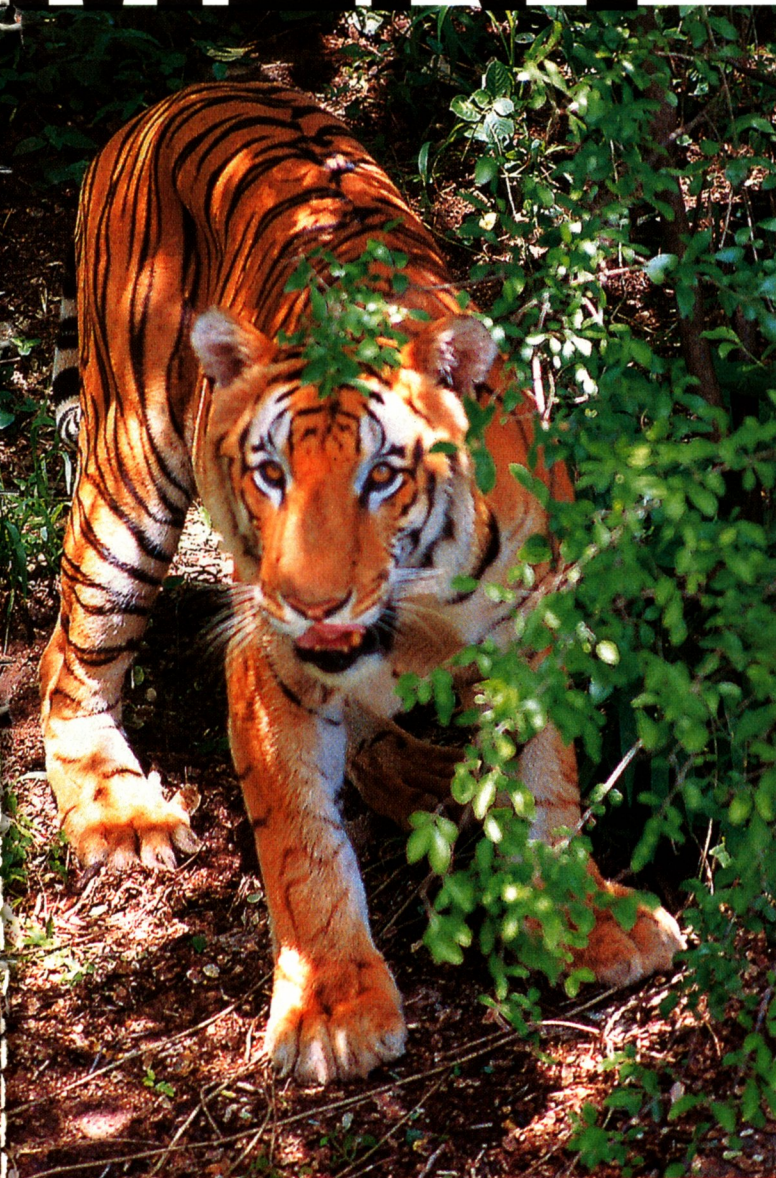


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things we did to change the environment

From the formation of Ministry of Environment and Forests to the judiciary's active involvement in implementing strict norms for checking vehicular pollution, the country has shown that activism can have impact

1 Firm Claw Project Tiger, 1973

The Rs 230-lakh Project Tiger was a Union Government and the World Wildlife Fund joint endeavour in 1973, to check immediate threats to the national animal. "It registered a marked increase in most animal populations in the first decade" (INDIA TODAY, December 1983). With 1,550 sq km under its canopy, including 15 sanctuaries and national parks, the project cordoned off a third of this land for conservation activities and demarcated the rest as a buffer area, relocating the villages around.

2 A Clean Domain NEERI, 1974

The National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (NEERI) brought to light the case of Hindustan Agro-Chemicals that had set up a chain of chemical units in Bichri, near Udaipur in the 1980s. "NEERI put the total damage suffered by the village at Rs 342 crore with the damage to the environment at around Rs 37 crore" (INDIA TODAY, March 1996).